“Did God Actually Say?”

Genesis 3:1–13

The big idea: The serpent questioned God’s word, denied his warning, and slandered his heart. Adam and Eve reached for what God had forbidden, and their eyes were opened to their own shame. Then God came looking for them.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 3:1–13 | Luke 19:1–10

Open (5 minutes)

Where do you see that the world is not the way it should be? What explanations for it have you heard?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

“Now the serpent was more _____ than any other beast of the field that the LORD God had made.” *(Genesis 3:1)*

The serpent told the woman, “You will not surely _____.” *(Genesis 3:4)*

The woman saw that the tree was good for food, “she took of its _____ and ate.” *(Genesis 3:6)*

Discuss

1. The serpent questioned God’s word, denied his warning, and slandered his heart. Which of those three do you find most tempting? Why? *Genesis 3:1–5*

2. Adam and Eve sewed fig leaves to cover their shame. What fig leaves do people use today to cover what they really are? Which ones do you reach for? *Genesis 3:7*

3. God knew exactly where they were, yet his first words after the fall were a question: “Where are you?” What does that tell you about him? *Genesis 3:8–9*

Memory verse

“For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost.”

Luke 19:10

Pray

Tell God honestly where you are. Name one fig leaf you hide behind, and thank him that he came looking for you in Jesus.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 7

“Did God Actually Say?”

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 3:1–13 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week’s reading (Genesis 3:14–24 and Romans 5:12–21).

Main points to land

1. Temptation works by making us doubt God’s word and God’s goodness. The serpent questioned, denied, and slandered, and never once said, Disobey (Genesis 3:1–5).
2. Sin brought shame, hiding, and blame. But God came looking: Where are you? He sought sinners before they sought him (Genesis 3:8–9; Luke 19:10).
3. Shame drives us to hide and to cover ourselves. Only God can cover us, and in Christ he does (Genesis 3:7–9, 21).

Answer key (Observe)

1. crafty
2. die
3. fruit

Questions people will ask

Was there really a talking snake?

Genesis calls the serpent a beast of the field that God had made (3:1), and the curse in 3:14 falls on an animal. From Augustine to Calvin, the church has read it this way: Satan, a fallen angel, spoke through a real creature (Revelation 12:9). Satan still disguises himself as an angel of light (2 Corinthians 11:14). Evil rarely comes looking evil.

Closing prayer

Father, we confess that we doubt your word and suspect your heart, and that we hide when we should come to you. Thank you that you came looking for us. Draw each of us out of hiding to Jesus, who came to seek and to save the lost. Amen.